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GNIOT Institute of Management Studies – PGDM (Batch 2022-24)
(TRIMESTER – III) END TERM EXAMINATION, APRIL - 2023
B2B MARKETING

[Time: 2 Hours 30 Minutes]

[Maximum Marks: 100]

INSTRUCTIONS:

- (i) There are **THREE** sections in this question paper.
- (ii) Attempt questions from each section as per the directions.
- (iii) Make suitable assumptions wherever necessary.

SECTION-A**(Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 100 words)****Q.1. Write short notes on the following:****(10×3=30)**

- (a) What are the characteristics of a B2B market environment?
- (b) What is content marketing?
- (c) Differentiate between traditional and modern tools of external communication.
- (d) What is blue collar marketing?
- (e) How can a marketer ensure customer satisfaction?
- (f) Elaborate measures of internal communication in an organisation.
- (g) Describe the benefits of using big data in marketing.
- (h) Why are product portfolio strategies used?
- (i) Briefly explain the concept of B2B 2.0.
- (j) Why is customer trust important in B2B marketing?

SECTION-B**(Long Answer Type Questions)****Attempt all questions of the following:****(4×10=40)****Q.2. (a)** Explain the major differences between consumer and business marketing.**OR****(b)** Consider any business marketing organization of your choice and develop an effective communication programme for the company?**Q.3. (a)** Explain the salient features of B2B market segmentation. Illustrate the same with changing trends in the industry.**OR****(b)** “Advertising and Sales Promotion are not the major techniques of Promoting Industrial Products.” Do you agree? Justify your answer**Q.4. (a)** “Are Ethics important for an organization ” Justify highlighting the unethical practices in an organization?**OR****(b)** SVC is a leading brand in the B2B category in the air freshening business in the hotel industry in Mumbai. As the Marketing Manager of SVC, suggest a suitable CRM strategy with the objective of stimulating the association with the customers.

Q.5. (a) Detail out the business buying process of an aluminum utensils manufacturer from a company like NALCO.

OR

(b) McKinsey provides consultancy services to large and medium size organizations. Should it go for Skimming pricing method, penetration pricing method or going-rate method? If you have any other method to suggest, please provide the same with reasons to do the same.

SECTION-C

Q.6. Attempt all parts of the following:

(2×15=30)

Autotech Pvt. Ltd.: Deciding Business Strategy

Sunil Shetty, Director, Autotech Pvt. Ltd., was not sure what kind of competitive strategy the company should adopt in the face of growing competition. The company was one of the leading manufacturers of service station equipment for two-wheeler service stations in the southern region of India. Autotech started its operations in 1995 in Bangalore and by 2007, it had become a dominant player in Southern India. The company adopted a focus strategy, by concentrating on superior quality of the equipment to the geographic segment of the four southern states of India—viz. Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and Kerala. Sunil Shetty discussed with the other two directors to invest in the new three-wheeler service station equipment and to launch the product in the market by end 2008. The company had the advantage that the new equipment would be needed by the existing two-wheeler service stations. This would minimize the cost of launching the new product. The major players in the three-wheelers market were Bajaj Auto (65 per cent market share) and Mahindra & Mahindra (17 per cent market share). However, TVS and Hero Honda were also planning to launch their three-wheeler commercial vehicles in 2008. Autotech did not find it necessary to have a marketing department. The company did not have any promotional strategy. The directors thought the company could not afford the marketing expenditure. The relationships with the existing customers were built by their service engineers. Sunil Shetty felt there was no need to develop new customers, since the existing customers were giving adequate business.

However, in the three-wheeler service station equipment there was already a dominant competitor and also there was a possibility of new players from other parts of India entering the southern regional market. Therefore, the question uppermost in the minds of Sunil Shetty and the other two directors was what kind of competitive strategy the company should now adopt in the changing marketing environment?

6(a) Do you agree to the company's existing business strategy? Should the company continue with the existing strategy in future or not? Give reasons.

6(b) Assuming the company should change its strategy to meet growing competition, what strategy do you suggest and why